Local search

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Code link: https://github.com/hnowakowski/Evolutionary-Computation-2026/blob/main/3_local/main.cpp

Description of the problem

We're trying to find a hamiltonian cycle where:

- function to be minimized is defined as distance + cost
- we want to have the cycle consist of exactly 50% of nodes
- distances between nodes are rounded euclidean

All solutions are described as a vector of subsequent node indices, their objectives were tested using the solution checker excel sheet

Pseudocode

All combinations of approaches tested:

1. greedy local search using a random initial solution with swapping edges as the intra-solution move
2. greedy local search using a random initial solution with swapping nodes as the intra-solution move
3. greedy local search using a greedy heuristic initial solution with swapping edges as the intra-solution move
4. greedy local search using a greedy heuristic initial solution with swapping nodes as the intra-solution move
5. steepest local search using a random initial solution with swapping edges as the intra-solution move
6. steepest local search using a random initial solution with swapping nodes as the intra-solution move
7. steepest local search using a greedy heuristic initial solution with swapping edges as the intra-solution move
8. steepest local search using a greedy heuristic initial solution with swapping nodes as the intra-solution move

The greedy heuristic choice was based on the best average score on the previous lab, so:

- Greedy cycle 2-regret weighted for TSPA
- Nearest neighbour 2-regret weighted for TSPB

For greedy variants, the std::mt19937 random number generator was used

Let's go over all the initial components first, since they are reused often

Calculating edge swap delta

given indices i, j, k, l i -> j, k -> l turns into i -> k, j -> l

```
delta = 0
delta -= matrix[i][j]
delta -= matrix[k][l]
delta += matrix[i][k]
delta += matrix[j][l]
return delta
```

Calculating intra node swap delta

given indices i, j

```
beforeI = (i == 0) ? sol.size() - 1 : i - 1
afterI = (i == sol.size() - 1) ? 0 : i + 1
beforeJ = (j == 0) ? sol.size() - 1 : j - 1
afterJ = (j == sol.size() - 1) ? 0 : j + 1
delta = 0
x = sol[i]
y = sol[j]

if (afterI == j) {
    delta -= matrix[sol[beforeI]][x]
    delta -= matrix[y][sol[afterJ]]
    delta += matrix[sol[beforeI]][y]
    delta += matrix[x][sol[afterJ]]
}
else if (i == 0 && j == sol.size() - 1) {
    delta -= matrix[sol[beforeJ]][y]
    delta -= matrix[x][sol[afterI]]
    delta += matrix[sol[beforeJ]][x]
    delta += matrix[y][sol[afterI]]
}
else {
    delta -= matrix[sol[beforeI]][x]
    delta -= matrix[x][sol[afterI]]
    delta -= matrix[sol[beforeJ]][y]
    delta -= matrix[y][sol[afterJ]]
    delta += matrix[sol[beforeI]][y]
    delta += matrix[y][sol[afterI]]
    delta += matrix[sol[beforeJ]][x]
    delta += matrix[x][sol[afterJ]]
}
return delta
```

Calculating inter node swap delta

given indices i, j where i is in the solution and j is outside

```
delta = 0
delta -= nodes[i].cost
delta += nodes[j].cost

beforeI = (i == 0) ? sol.size() - 1 : i - 1
afterI = (i == sol.size() - 1) ? 0 : i + 1
x = sol[i]
delta -= matrix[sol[beforeI]][x]
delta -= matrix[x][sol[afterI]]
delta += matrix[sol[beforeI]][j]
delta += matrix[j][sol[afterI]]
return delta
```

Local search greedy edges

```
solution = initial_algorithm()
bool[200] contains
populate contains with all nodes in solution

vector<array[2]> nodeSwapPoolInter
populate with all possible node swaps

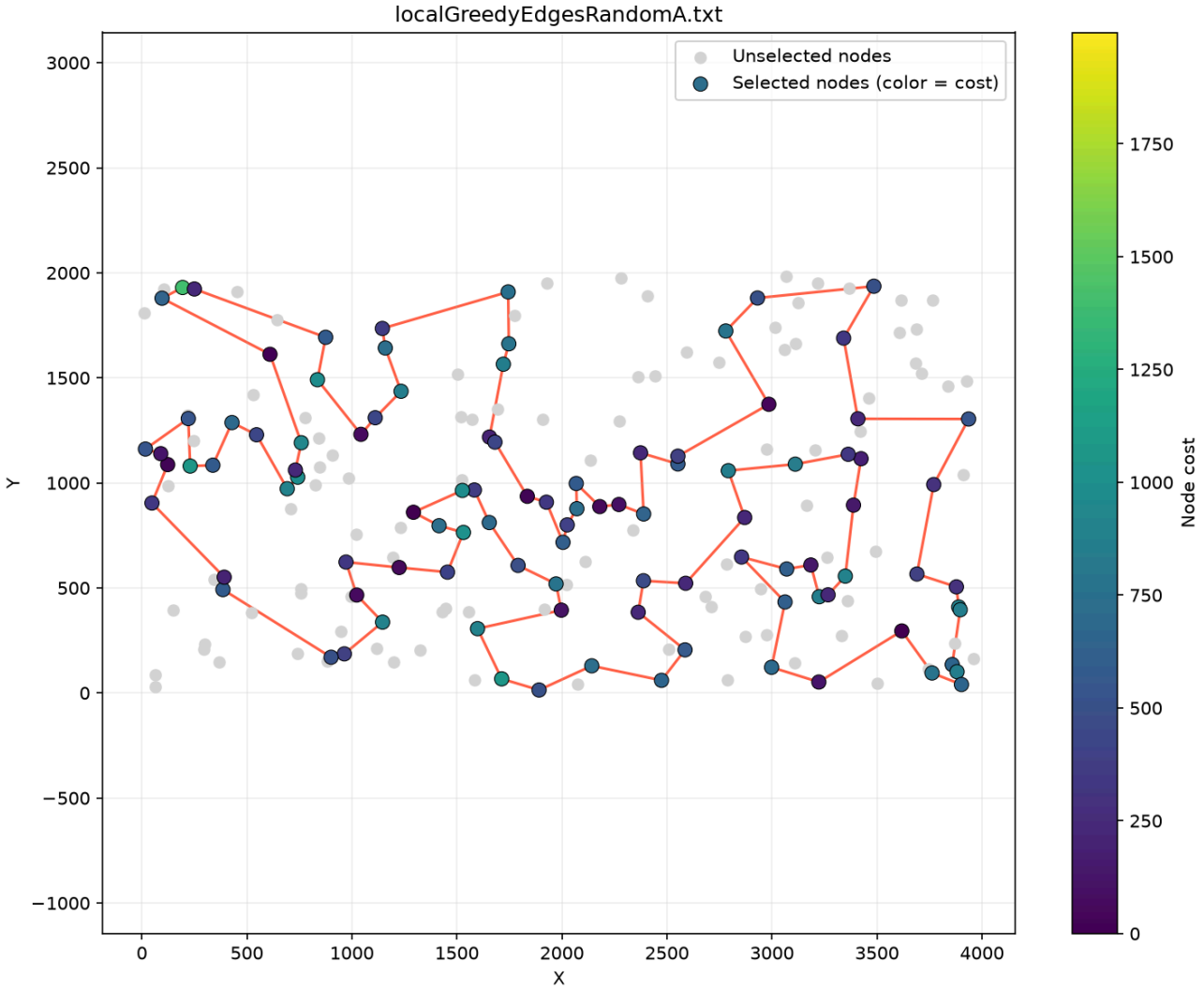
vector<array[4]> edgeSwapPool
populate with all possible edge swaps

while at least one pool is not empty{
    improved = false
    choice = randomly pick 0 or 1
    if (choice == 1 and nodeSwapPoolInter not empty){
        randomly pick index from 0 to nodeSwapPoolInter.size - 1
        fetch and pop selected swap from the pool
        calculate delta
        if (delta < 0){
            replace node in solution
            update contains
            improved = true
        }
    }
    else{
        if(edgeSwapPool not empty){
            randomly pick index from 0 to edgeSwapPool.size - 1
            fetch and pop selected swap from the pool
            calculate delta
            if (delta < 0){
                replace edge in solution
                improved = true
            }
        }
    }
    if (improved){
```

```
            clear and reset both pools
        }
    }
    return solution
```

Random initial solution - TSPA

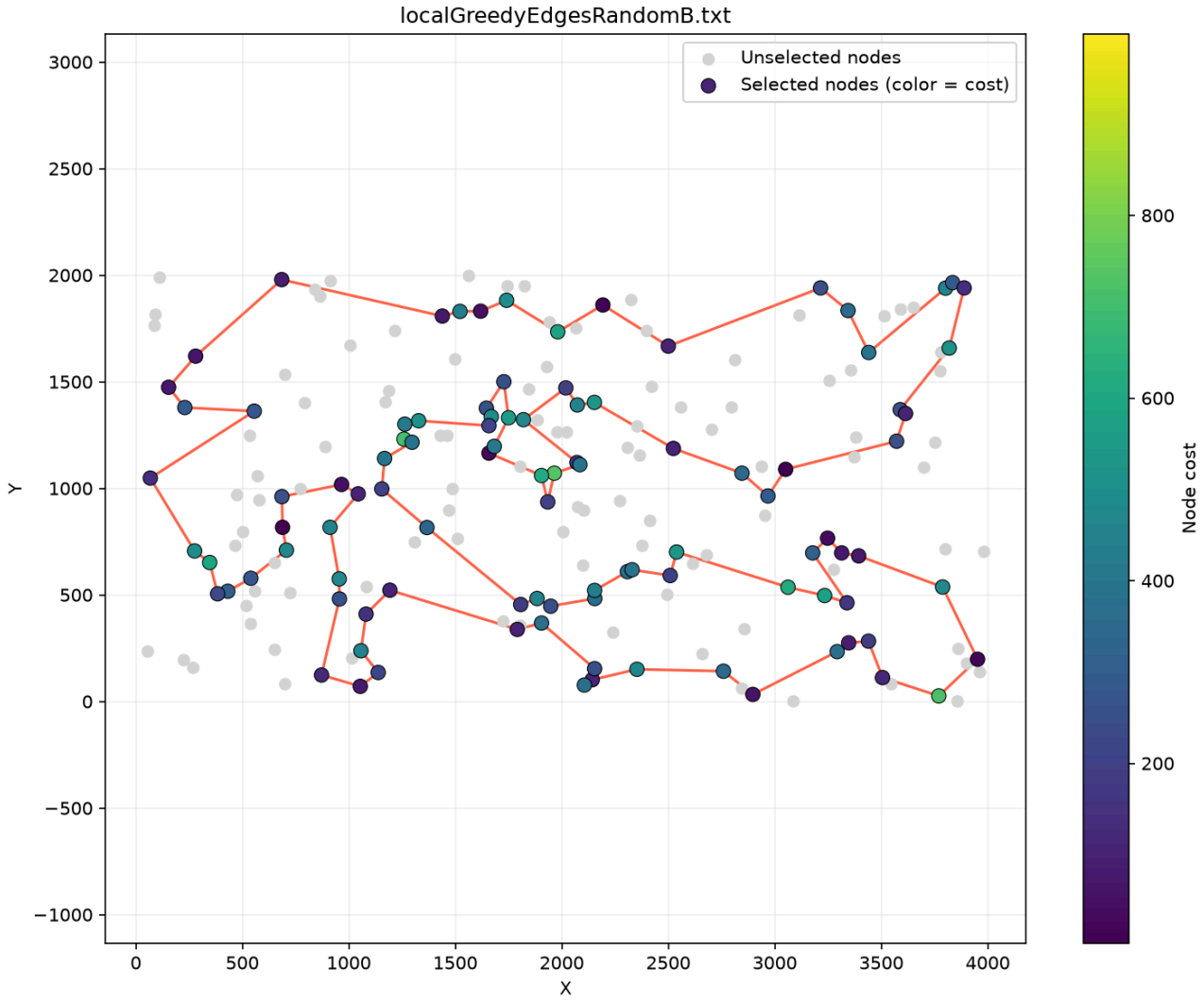
Max objective: 79550
Average objective: 76462
Min objective: 73699
Runtime: 1.19438 s




```
71 157 115 112 139 51 16 67 144 140 53 179 52 177 36 131 33 54 9 164 186 136 29
178 1 147 47 130 159 146 170 153 193 78 88 107 57 182 151 176 150 106 42 89 113 93
50 3 85 8 174 134 84 58 158 192 181 114 25 98 135 73 45 185 35 156 180 28 102 87
141 30 187 189 2 171 127 97 168 63 149 116 60 11 49 108 152 160 83 123 100 80 31 7
48 91 38 132 76 4
```

Random initial solution - TSPB

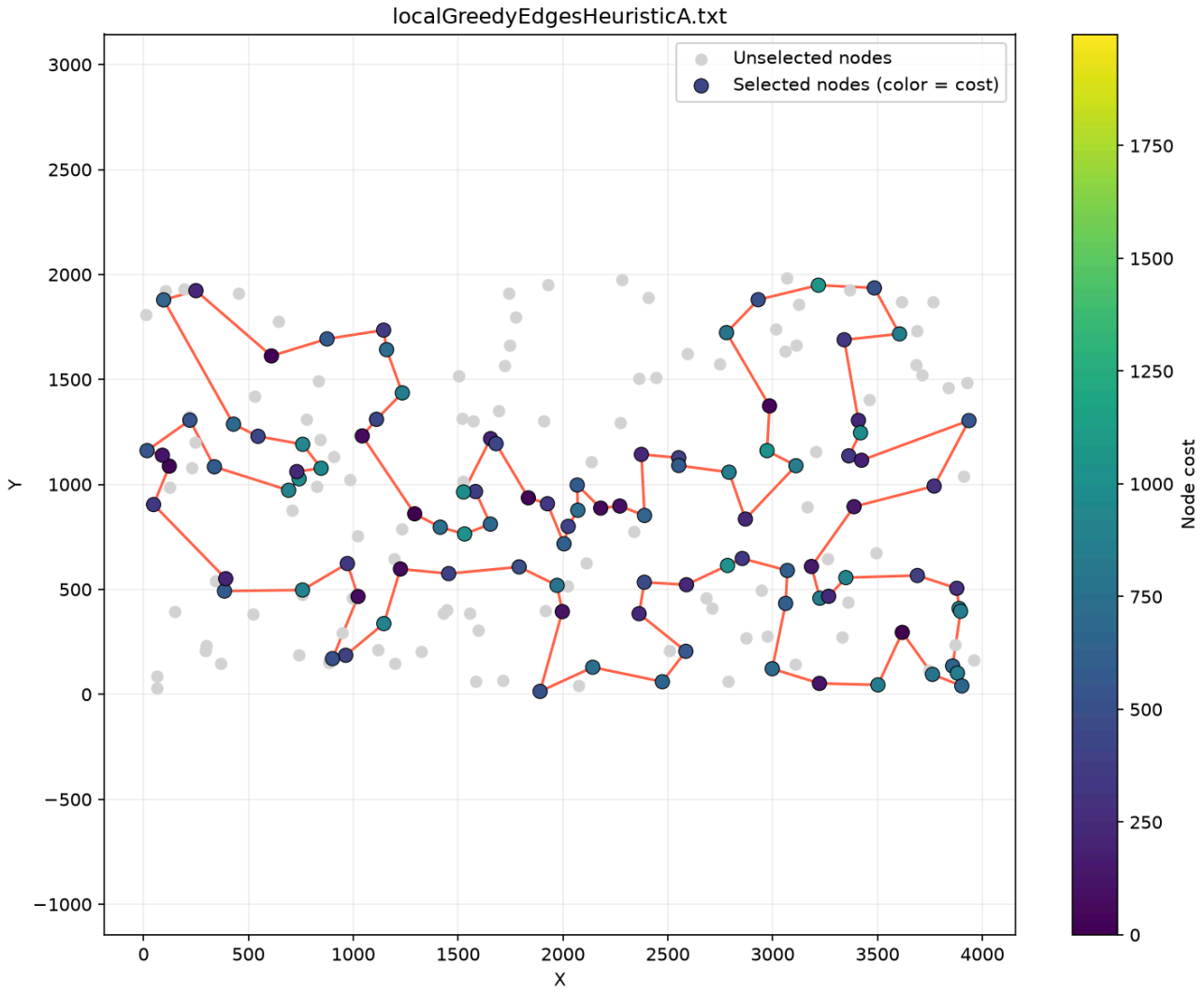
Max objective: 55870
Average objective: 53075
Min objective: 50767
Runtime: 1.03015 s




```
76 86 46 72 117 184 3 173 151 122 69 160 8 120 133 136 172 183 30 176 21 38 47 64
59 73 167 181 152 34 24 67 66 150 182 153 80 127 129 90 118 110 93 2 14 20 74 171
99 88 87 82 179 51 85 40 60 157 45 134 175 71 155 97 140 154 125 170 115 6 29 132
103 178 65 158 145 28 149 116 121 198 96 48 156 89 57 190 70 187 81 94 105 61 196
114 10 54 192 162
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPA

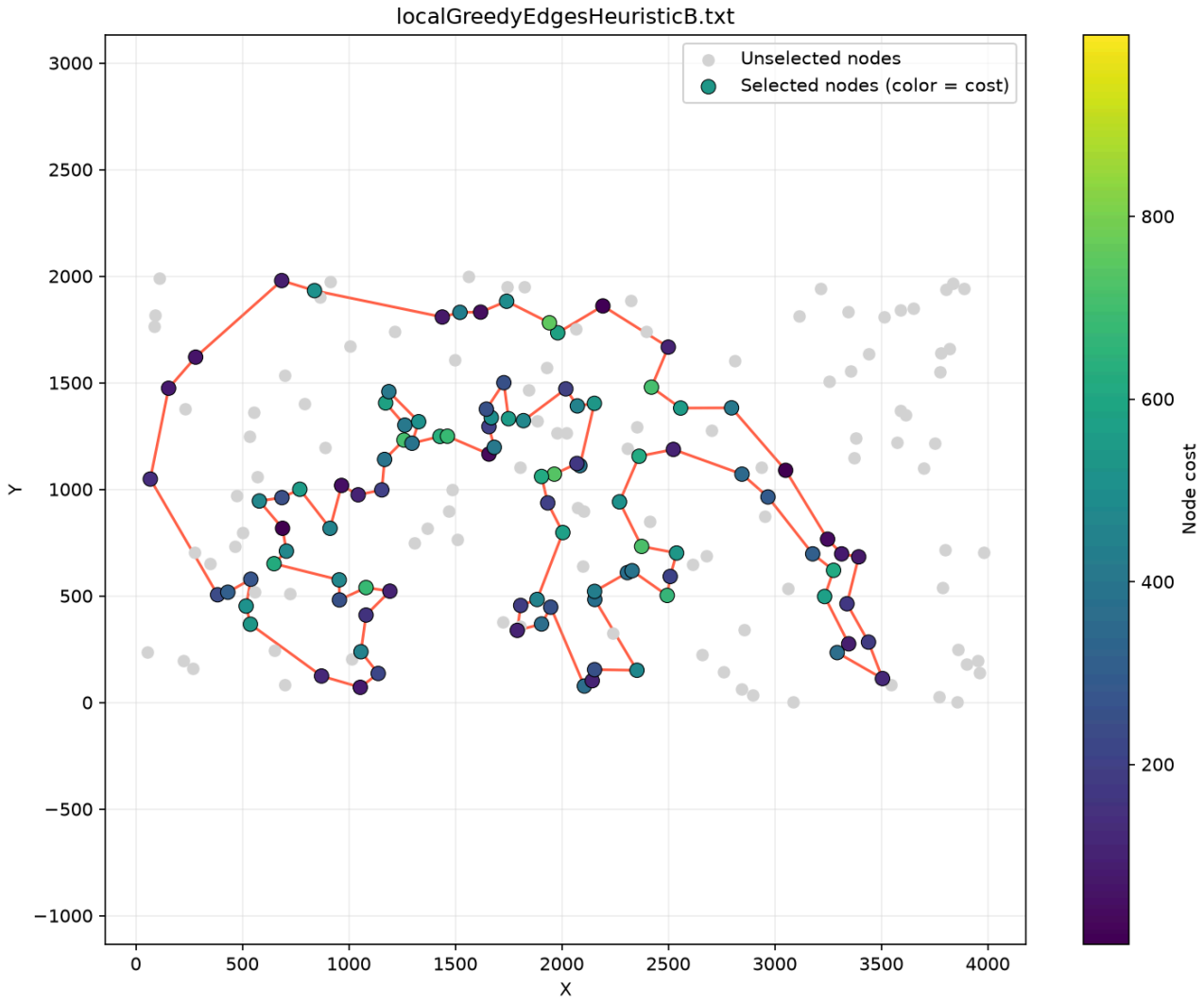
Max objective: 74487
Average objective: 72968
Min objective: 72192
Runtime: 0.176329 s




```
152 108 31 48 80 91 157 71 4 76 132 180 28 102 185 35 156 51 16 67 144 140 53 179
52 177 36 131 33 9 54 8 174 85 142 164 186 136 163 29 101 178 1 169 3 50 147 47 93
106 42 89 113 130 159 146 170 153 193 78 88 107 64 57 182 151 150 176 72 134 84 58
158 192 181 114 135 73 45 87 141 189 2 171 187 30 161 127 97 168 63 149 116 60 49
160 83 123 90 100
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPB

Max objective: 60241
Average objective: 55314
Min objective: 51975
Runtime: 0.220489 s




```
36 175 134 45 157 60 40 141 71 155 180 115 170 177 125 26 97 154 140 47 38 176 30
191 130 183 21 189 168 69 160 172 136 133 120 8 117 72 46 86 3 184 173 122 151 98
73 59 85 51 167 82 87 179 88 181 152 34 24 31 67 66 11 27 135 76 162 192 80 52 182
20 74 2 14 153 90 129 127 54 104 185 79 57 89 156 43 48 96 198 121 147 116 149 28
65 132 29 6 197
```

Local search greedy nodes

```
solution = initial_algorithm()
bool[200] contains
populate contains with all nodes in solution

vector<array[2]> nodeSwapPoolInter
populate with all possible node swaps

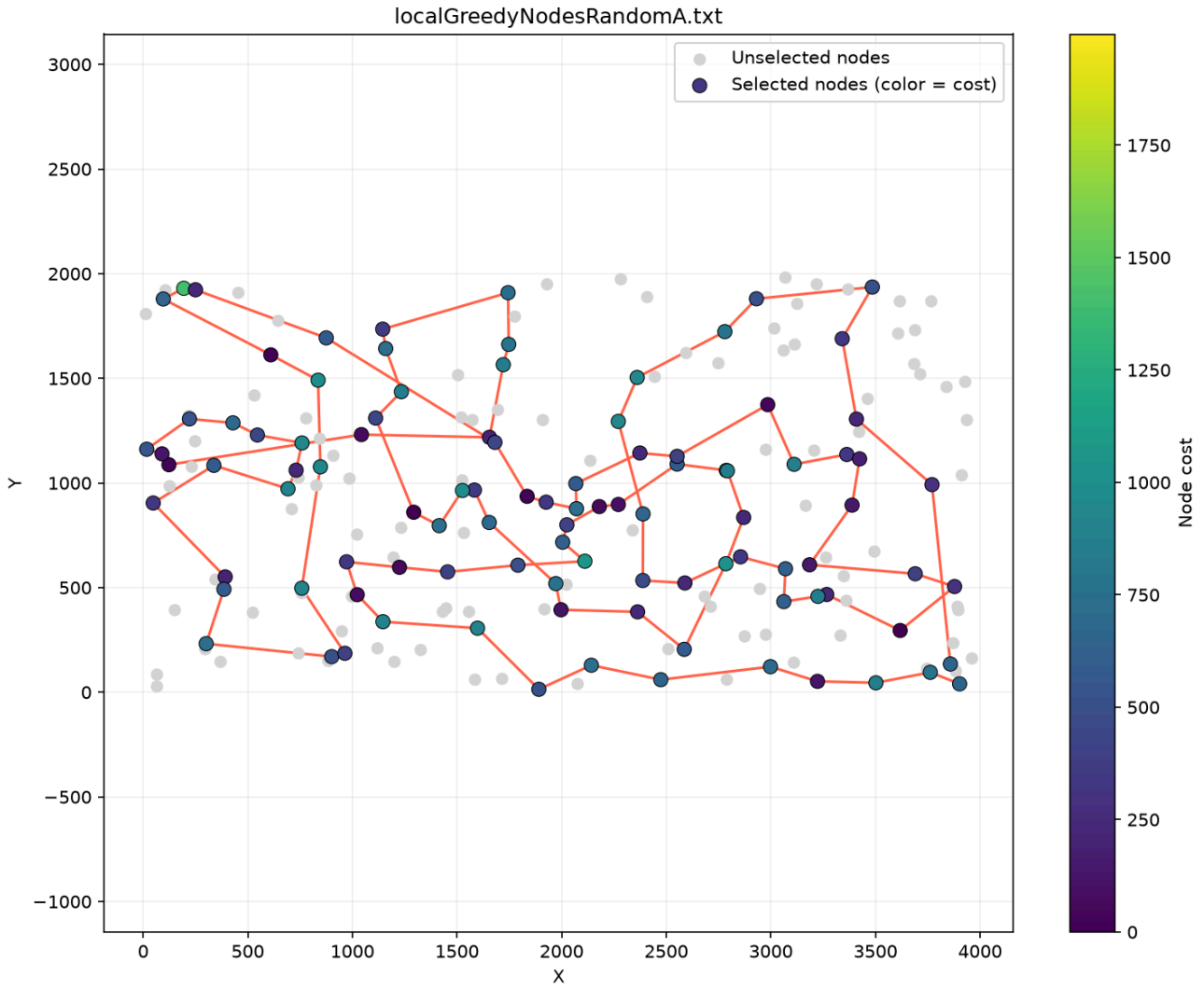
vector<array[2]> nodeSwapPoolIntra
populate with all possible node swaps

while at least one pool is not empty{
    improved = false
```

```
    choice = randomly pick 0 or 1
    if (choice == 1 and nodeSwapPoolInter not empty){
        randomly pick index from 0 to nodeSwapPoolInter.size - 1
        fetch and pop selected swap from the pool
        calculate delta
        if (delta < 0){
            replace node in solution
            update contains
            improved = true
        }
    }
    else{
        if(nodeSwapPoolIntra not empty){
            randomly pick index from 0 to nodeSwapPoolIntra.size - 1
            fetch and pop selected swap from the pool
            calculate delta
            if (delta < 0){
                swap nodes in solution
                improved = true
            }
        }
    }
    if (improved){
        clear and reset both pools
    }
}
return solution
```

Random initial solution - TSPA

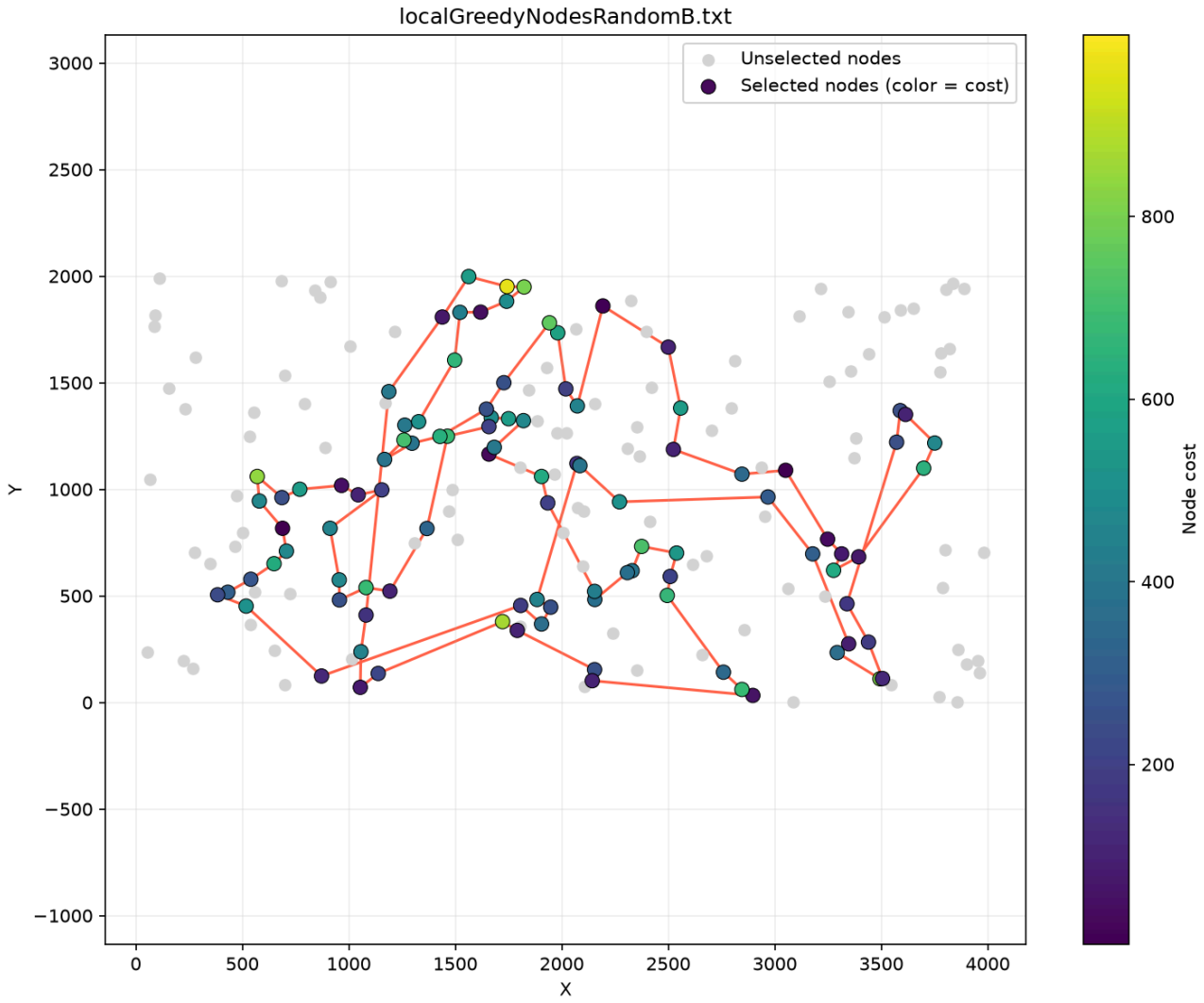
Max objective: 93632
Average objective: 87865
Min objective: 80627
Runtime: 1.07035 s




```
176 134 84 131 143 62 186 136 29 178 1 47 153 78 88 64 57 182 192 181 114 98 189
187 30 141 87 45 41 140 53 177 36 54 194 8 174 72 158 58 135 73 185 35 156 28 180
76 4 71 157 115 112 139 51 132 63 149 116 60 108 152 100 123 160 49 168 97 127 69
171 2 161 90 38 80 31 7 48 91 16 67 144 179 52 33 9 164 85 3 50 93 106 130 159 107
89 42 151 150
```

Random initial solution - TSPB

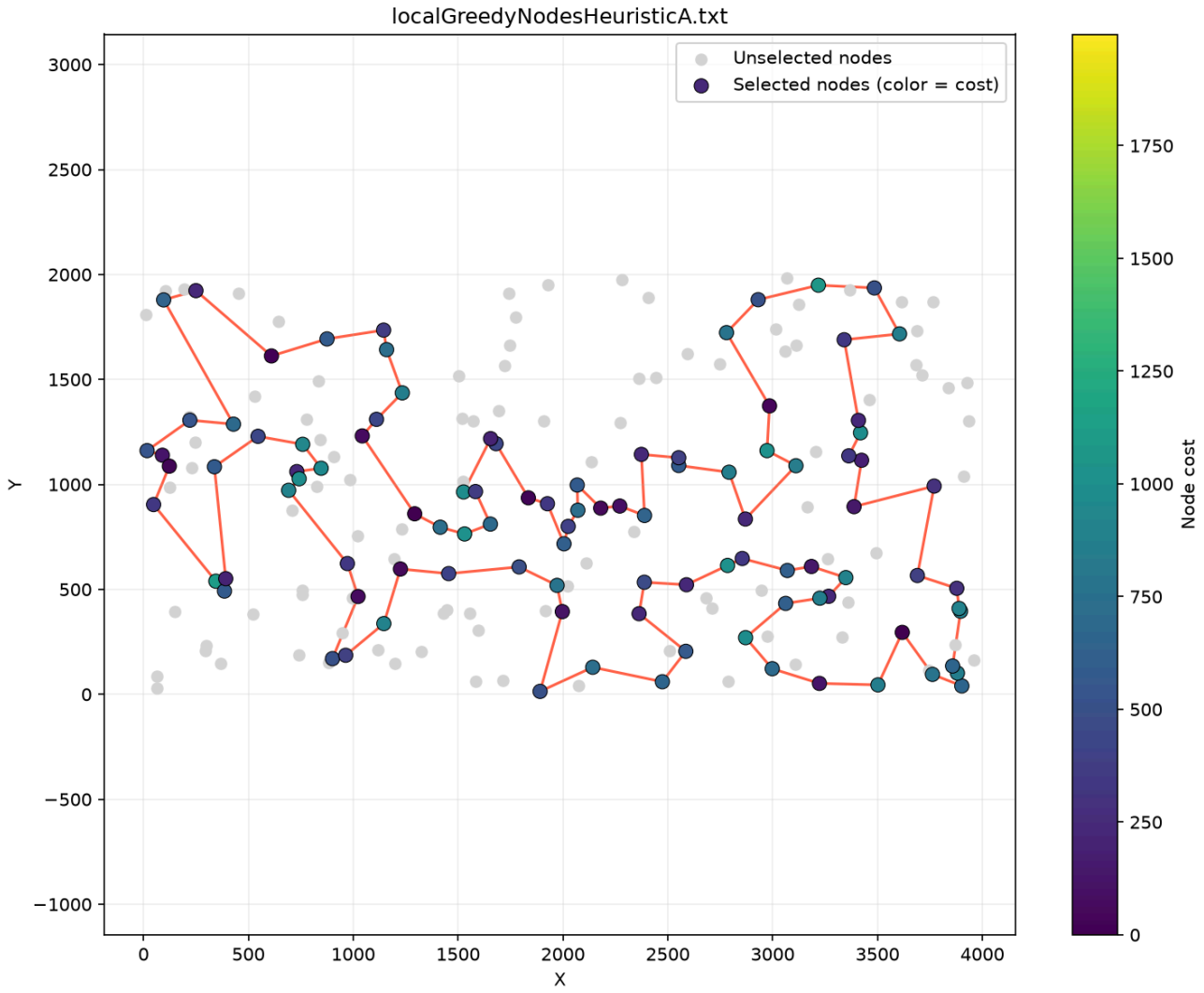
Max objective: 70609
Average objective: 64189
Min objective: 58613
Runtime: 1.06005 s




```
69 160 117 8 136 172 168 64 40 141 71 155 97 47 140 154 26 125 55 177 170 115 180
6 29 132 197 175 59 51 167 73 184 3 27 192 80 20 74 188 2 14 153 10 196 114 148
143 90 52 129 127 54 162 76 185 57 89 46 72 156 43 120 133 189 21 38 176 30 183 63
198 96 48 164 16 58 121 130 60 157 134 45 107 85 179 87 171 39 99 31 67 66 11 24
34 181 152 151 122
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPA

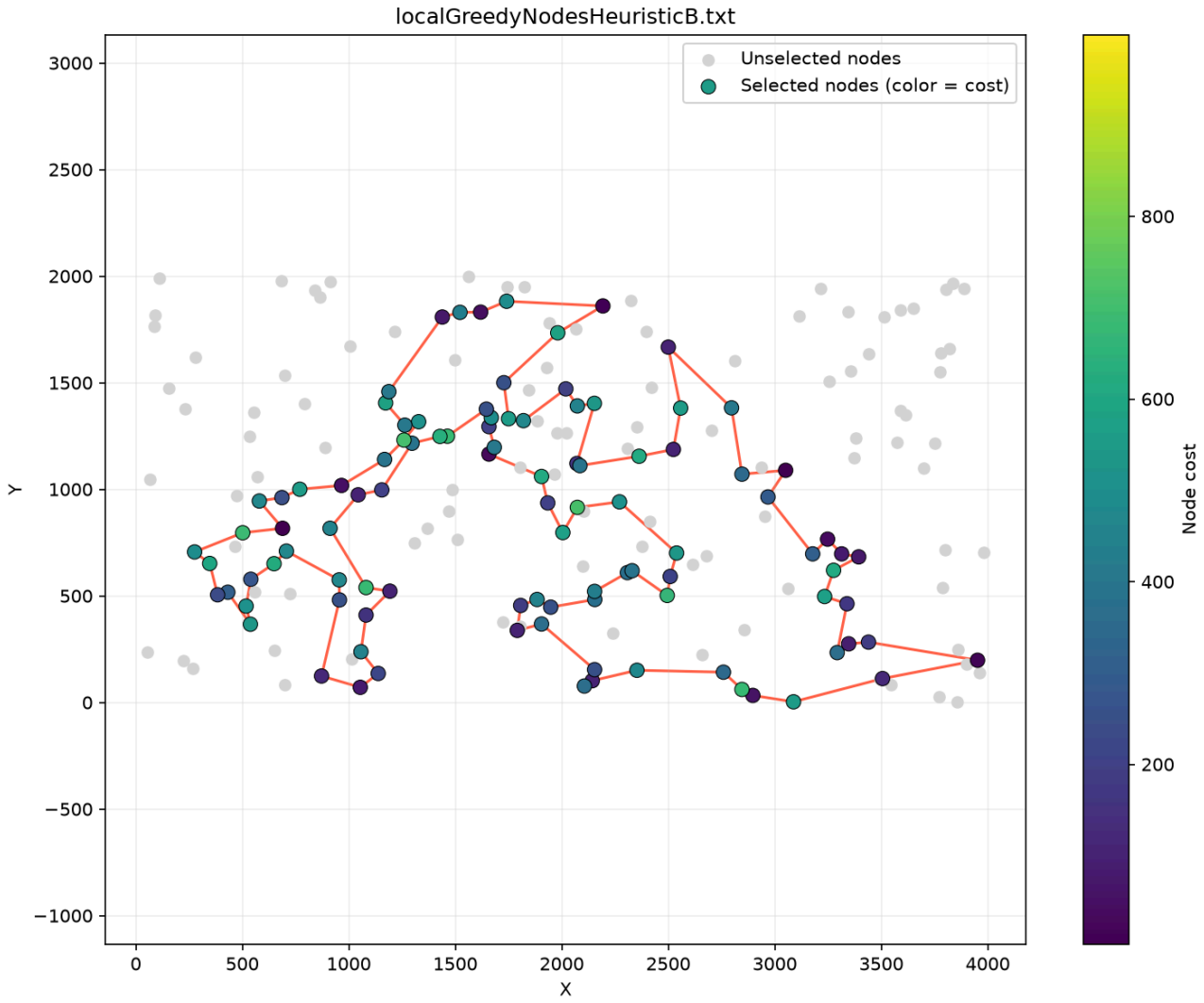
Max objective: 74658
Average objective: 73114
Min objective: 72261
Runtime: 0.275943 s




```
174 8 54 9 33 131 36 177 52 179 53 140 144 67 16 51 156 35 185 102 28 180 132 76 4
71 157 91 80 48 31 108 60 116 149 63 168 95 127 97 49 152 100 90 123 83 160 30 187
171 2 189 141 87 45 73 135 114 181 192 158 58 84 134 72 176 150 106 113 89 42 151
138 182 57 64 107 88 78 193 153 170 146 159 130 47 93 50 3 169 1 178 101 29 163
136 186 164 142 85
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPB

Max objective: 61478
Average objective: 55636
Min objective: 52247
Runtime: 0.308007 s




```
17 171 39 99 88 87 82 179 51 85 59 73 167 181 152 34 24 31 67 66 27 111 98 151 122
69 160 172 136 133 168 189 21 47 140 97 141 40 60 157 45 134 175 71 155 115 180 6
197 36 29 132 103 178 19 170 177 125 26 154 38 176 183 30 191 130 121 198 96 48 89
156 120 8 117 72 46 86 184 3 135 76 185 57 104 162 54 192 80 127 129 90 52 182 153
74 20 14 110 2
```

Local search steepest edges

```
solution = initial_algorithm()
bool[200] contains
populate contains with all nodes in solution

vector<array[2]> nodeSwapPoolInter
populate with all possible node swaps

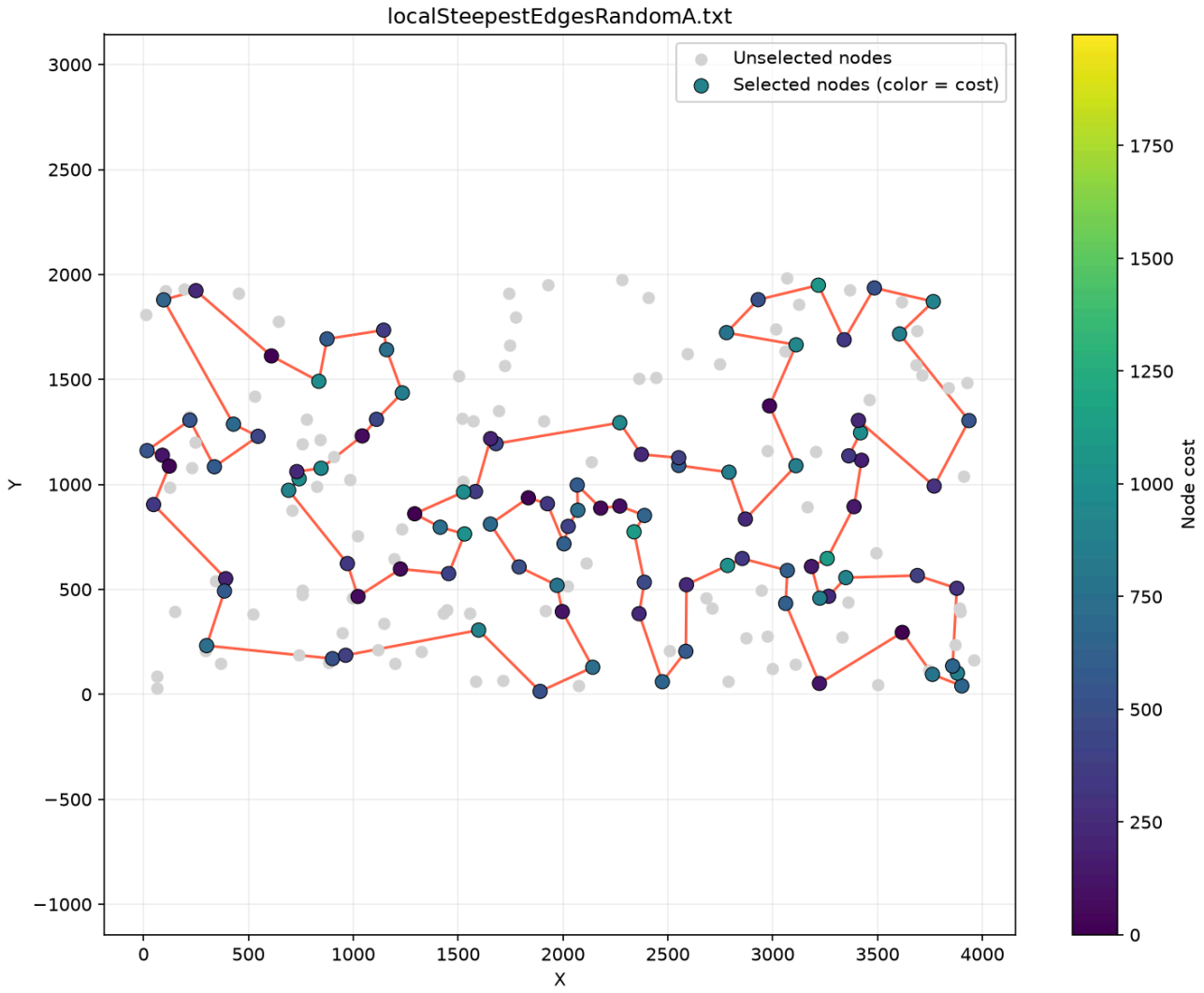
vector<array[4]> edgeSwapPool
populate with all possible edge swaps

while true{
    bestDelta = 0
```

```
      bestIdx = 0
      isInterBest = false
      for idx from 0 to nodeSwapPoolInter.size {
          fetch selected swap from the pool
          calculate delta
          if (delta > bestDelta){
              bestIdx = idx
              isInterbest = true
              bestDelta = delta
          }
      }
      for idx from 0 to edgeSwapPool.size {
          fetch selected swap from the pool
          calculate delta
          if (delta > bestDelta){
              bestIdx = idx
              isInterbest = false
              bestDelta = delta
          }
      }
      if (bestDelta < 0){
          if(isInterbest){
              perform swap from nodeSwapPoolInter[bestIdx]
              update contains
          }
          else{
              perform swap from edgeSwapPool[bestIdx]
          }
          clear and reset both pools
      }
      else break
  }
  return solution
```

Random initial solution - TSPA

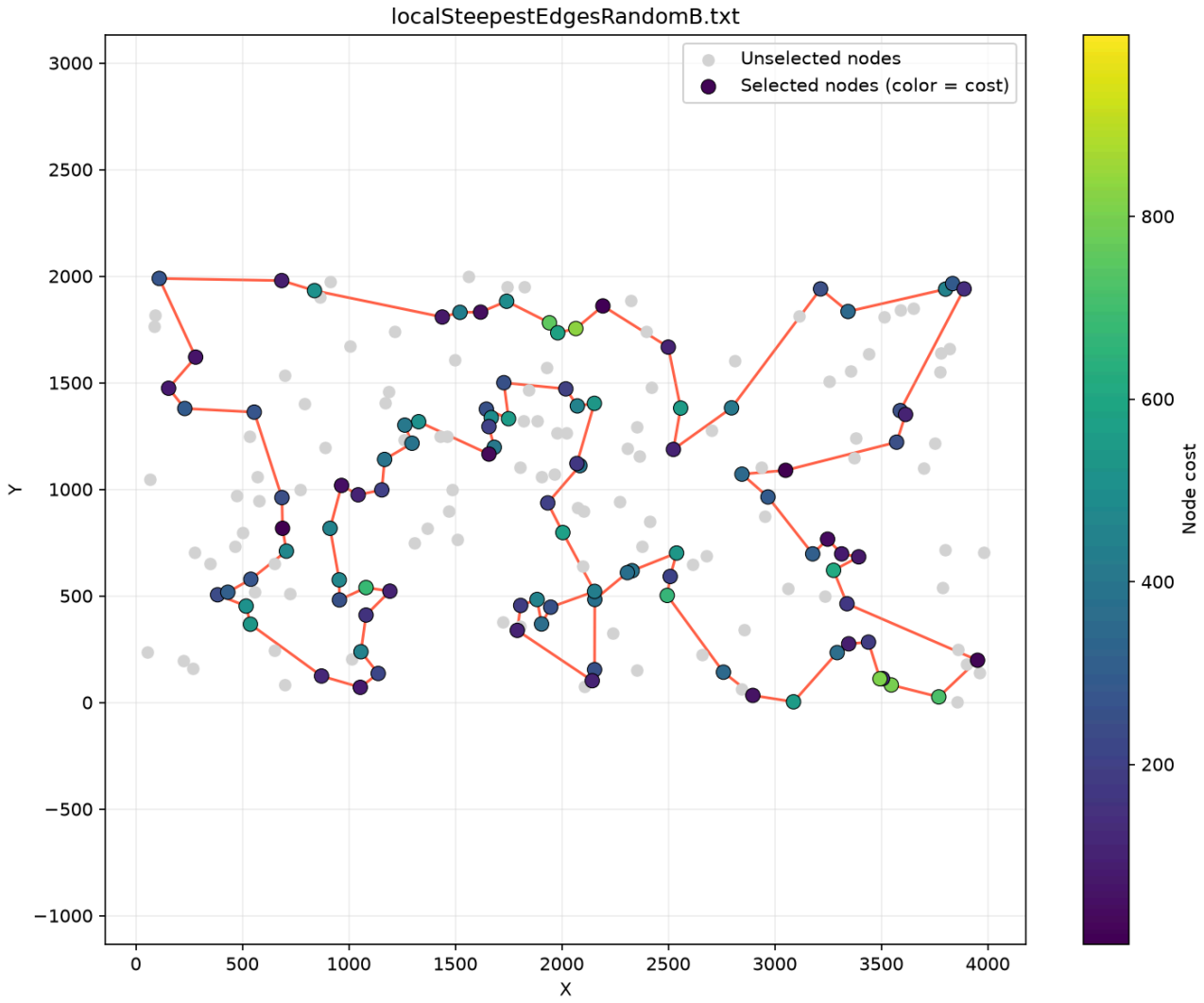
Max objective: 79004
Average objective: 76344
Min objective: 73968
Runtime: 0.771506 s




```
113 89 42 106 43 93 50 3 169 1 47 147 101 55 29 178 163 136 186 184 164 85 174 8
54 9 33 143 16 51 35 156 180 28 102 87 141 187 30 160 83 123 90 132 76 4 71 157 91
38 80 48 31 108 152 49 60 116 149 63 168 97 127 69 171 2 98 114 181 135 73 45 185
67 144 140 53 179 52 177 36 131 99 84 58 192 158 134 72 176 150 151 57 107 88 78
193 153 159 130
```

Random initial solution - TSPB

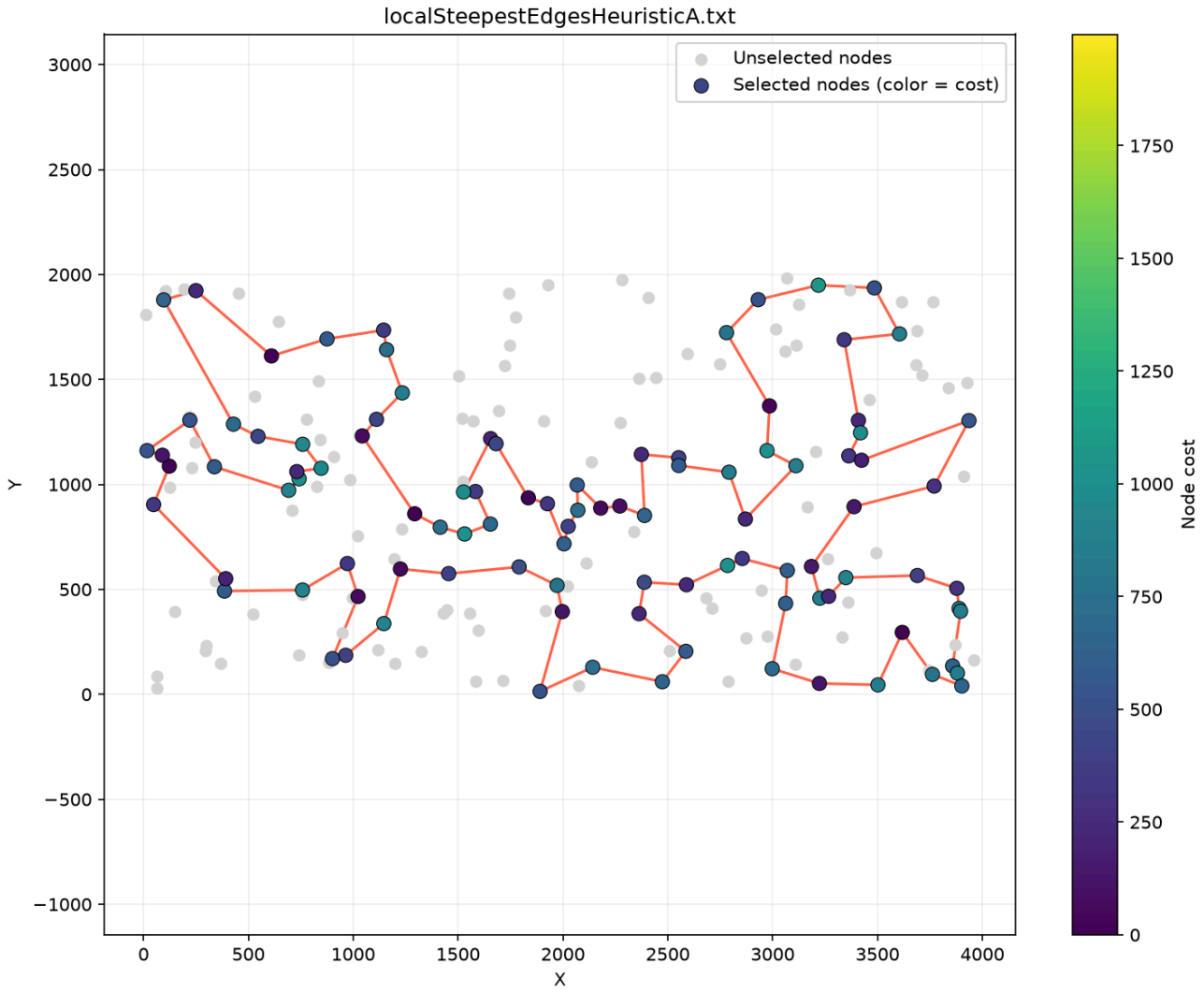
Max objective: 54536
Average objective: 52345
Min objective: 50554
Runtime: 0.639972 s




```
110 93 9 2 188 14 20 74 17 171 99 31 67 66 24 34 181 179 87 85 59 73 51 167 152 98
151 3 184 86 46 72 120 8 133 136 172 160 69 183 30 21 38 47 140 154 97 155 71 141
40 60 157 45 134 175 36 197 132 29 6 115 170 125 158 145 28 149 37 116 147 121 198
96 48 43 156 32 89 57 185 76 104 190 70 81 94 105 196 114 10 54 162 192 80 127 129
90 52 153
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPA

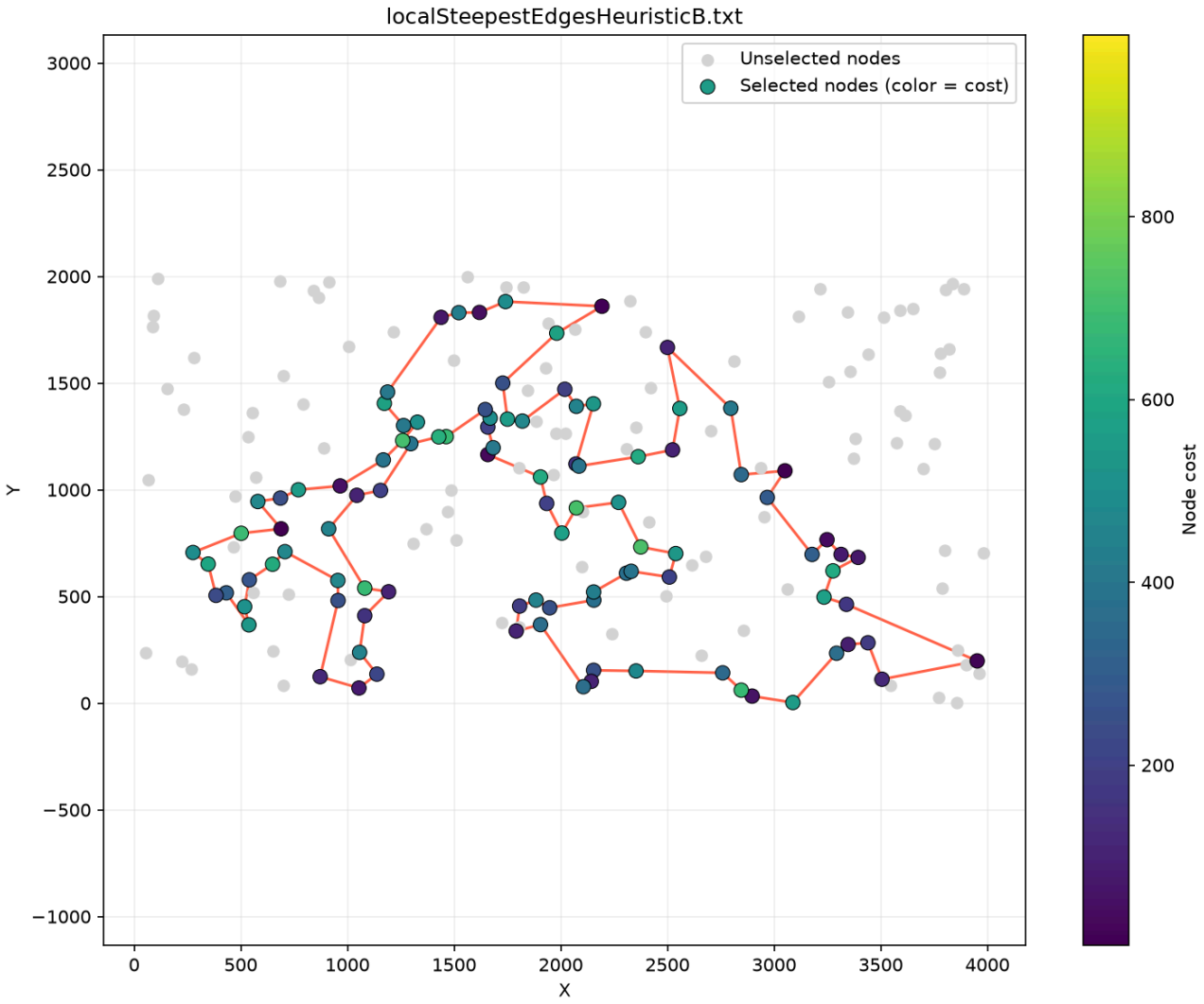
Max objective: 74466
Average objective: 72981
Min objective: 72192
Runtime: 0.153551 s




```
152 108 31 48 80 91 157 71 4 76 132 180 28 102 185 35 156 51 16 67 144 140 53 179
52 177 36 131 33 9 54 8 174 85 142 164 186 136 163 29 101 178 1 169 3 50 147 47 93
106 42 89 113 130 159 146 170 153 193 78 88 107 64 57 182 151 150 176 72 134 84 58
158 192 181 114 135 73 45 87 141 189 2 171 187 30 161 127 97 168 63 149 116 60 49
160 83 123 90 100
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPB

Max objective: 60144
Average objective: 55312
Min objective: 52166
Runtime: 0.160574 s




```
17 171 39 99 88 179 87 82 51 85 59 73 167 181 152 34 24 67 66 11 27 111 98 151 122
69 160 172 136 133 168 189 21 47 140 97 141 40 60 157 45 134 175 71 155 115 180 6
197 36 29 132 103 178 19 170 177 125 26 154 38 176 183 30 191 130 121 198 96 48 89
156 120 8 117 72 46 86 184 3 135 76 185 57 104 162 54 192 80 127 129 90 52 182 153
110 2 14 20 74
```

Local search steepest nodes

```
solution = initial_algorithm()
bool[200] contains
populate contains with all nodes in solution

vector<array[2]> nodeSwapPoolInter
populate with all possible node swaps

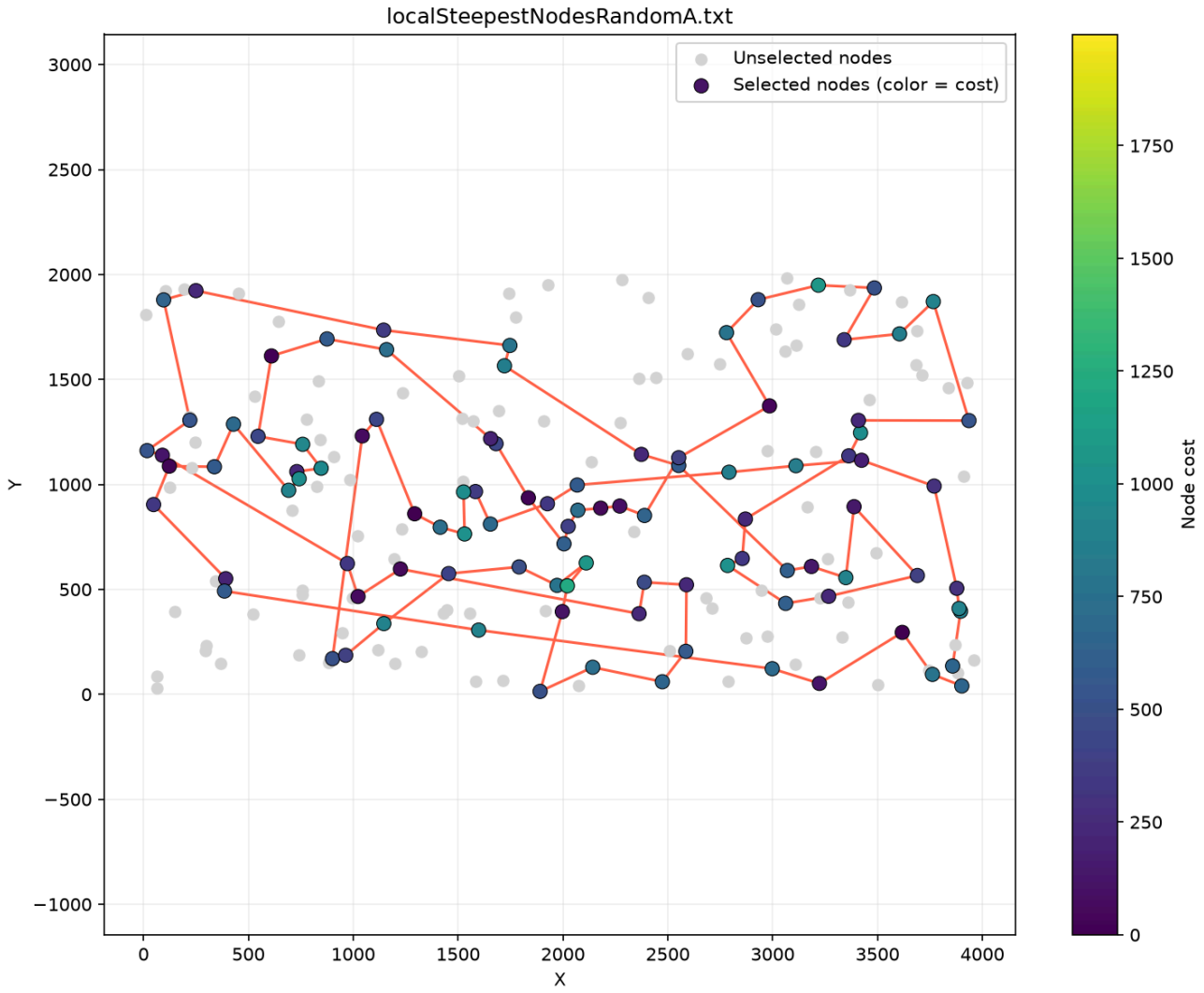
vector<array[2]> nodeSwapIntra
populate with all possible node swaps

while true{
    bestDelta = 0
```

```
      bestIdx = 0
      isInterBest = false
      for idx from 0 to nodeSwapPoolInter.size {
          fetch selected swap from the pool
          calculate delta
          if (delta > bestDelta){
              bestIdx = idx
              isInterbest = true
              bestDelta = delta
          }
      }
      for idx from 0 to nodeSwapIntra.size {
          fetch selected swap from the pool
          calculate delta
          if (delta > bestDelta){
              bestIdx = idx
              isInterbest = false
              bestDelta = delta
          }
      }
      if (bestDelta < 0){
          if(isInterbest){
              perform swap from nodeSwapPoolInter[bestIdx]
              update contains
          }
          else{
              perform swap from nodeSwapIntra[bestIdx]
          }
          clear and reset both pools
      }
      else break
  }
  return solution
```

Random initial solution - TSPA

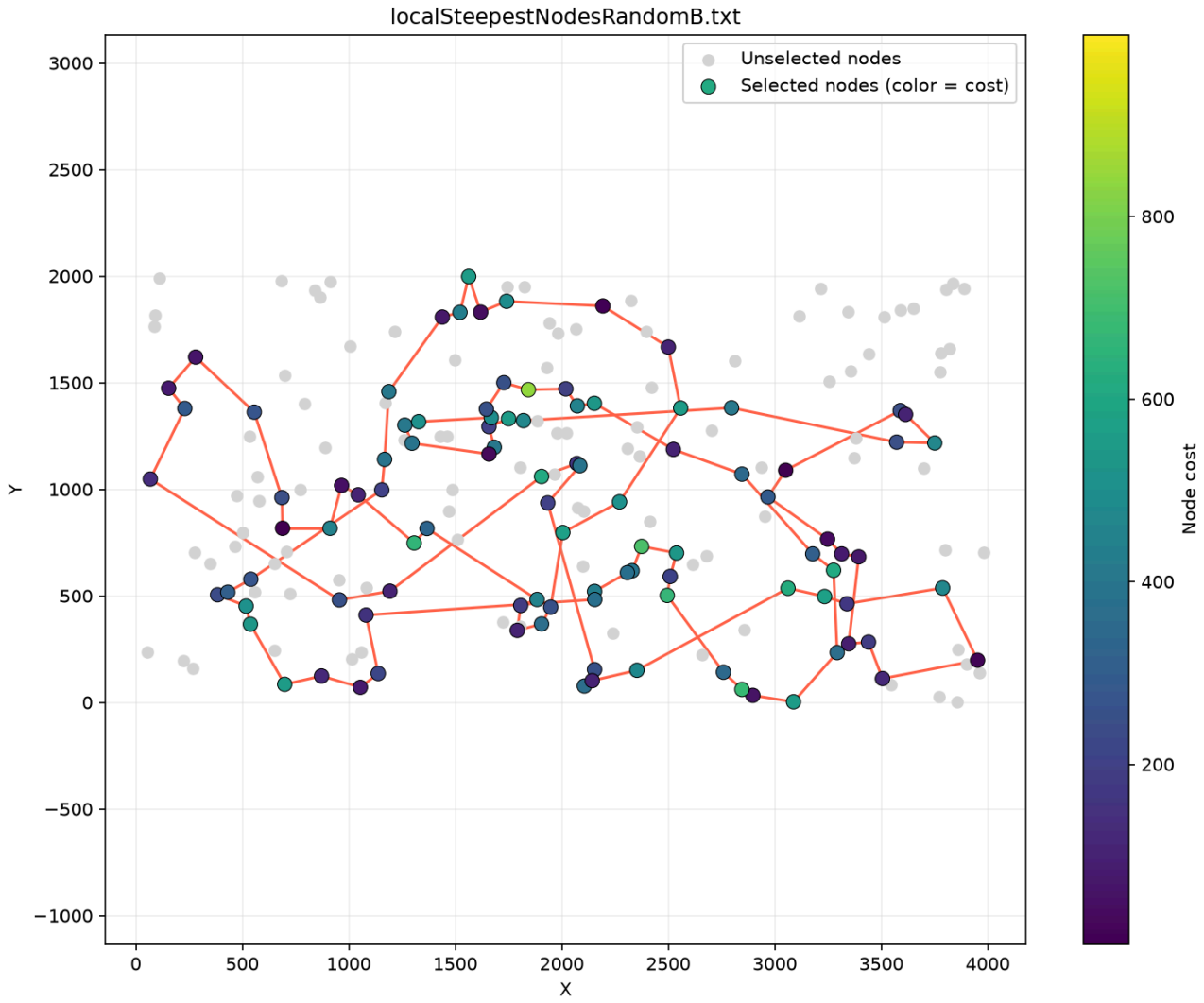
Max objective: 98326
Average objective: 89686
Min objective: 82908
Runtime: 1.08513 s




```
135 114 181 192 158 134 84 58 141 187 30 149 116 60 31 48 157 112 139 33 54 150
106 113 93 130 89 151 72 176 174 3 169 1 147 55 101 178 29 163 136 186 164 9 131
36 177 179 53 140 67 16 51 71 91 80 152 100 90 123 83 160 108 49 63 168 97 127 98
182 57 107 88 78 153 170 146 159 47 50 85 8 52 144 185 35 156 102 28 180 76 132
171 2 189 87 45 73 41 61
```

Random initial solution - TSPB

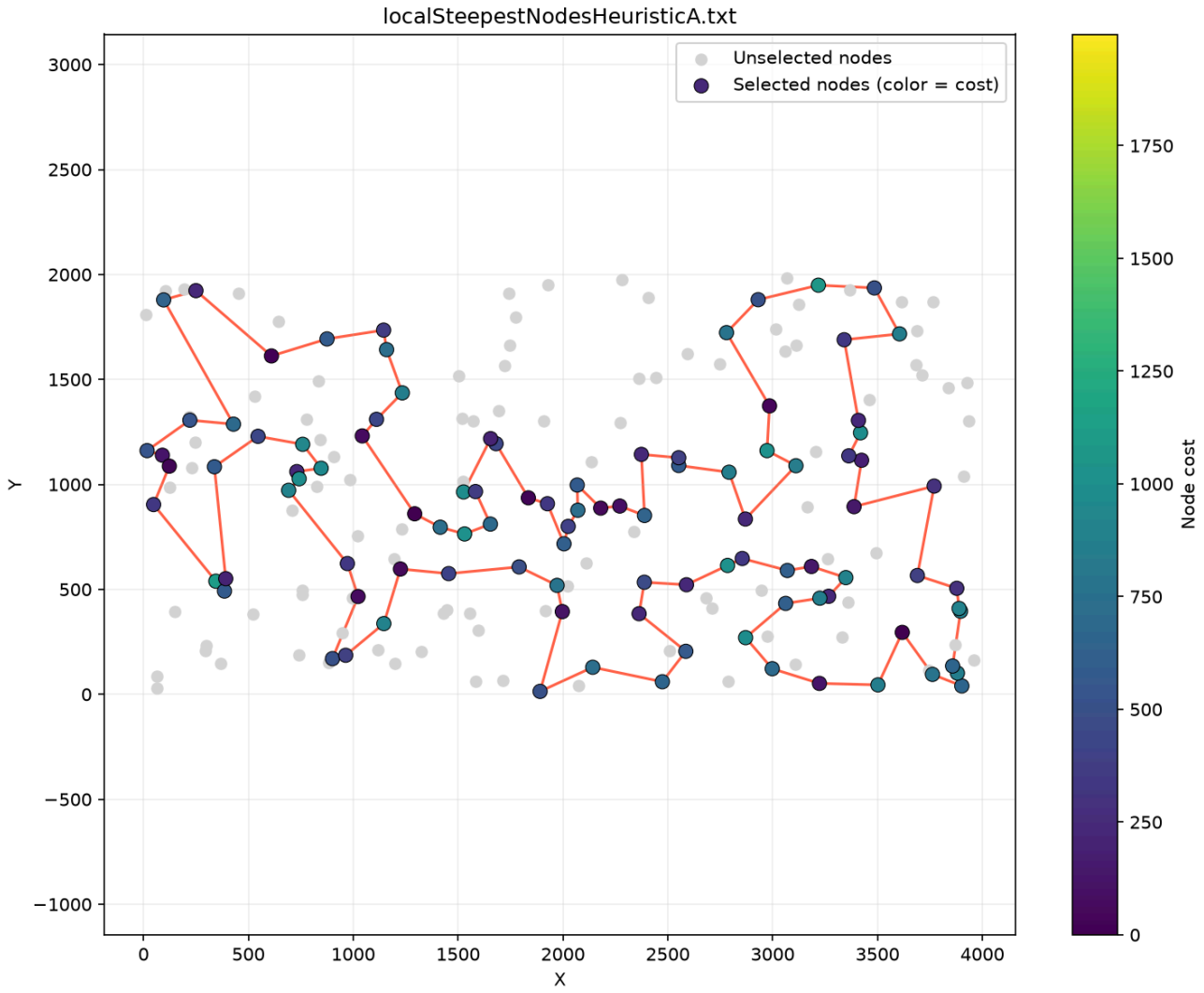
Max objective: 74250
Average objective: 65952
Min objective: 58036
Runtime: 0.974931 s




```
52 74 17 171 39 99 31 67 66 11 24 34 152 181 60 45 134 175 62 36 197 132 29 6 47
38 130 121 198 58 96 48 89 57 185 27 98 167 51 85 59 73 64 33 140 154 97 170 125
158 149 28 145 65 71 40 122 184 3 151 179 82 87 88 150 182 153 118 110 2 14 20 90
129 127 192 54 196 114 148 10 104 117 8 172 160 69 21 30 183 136 133 120 92 72 46
86 76 162 80
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPA

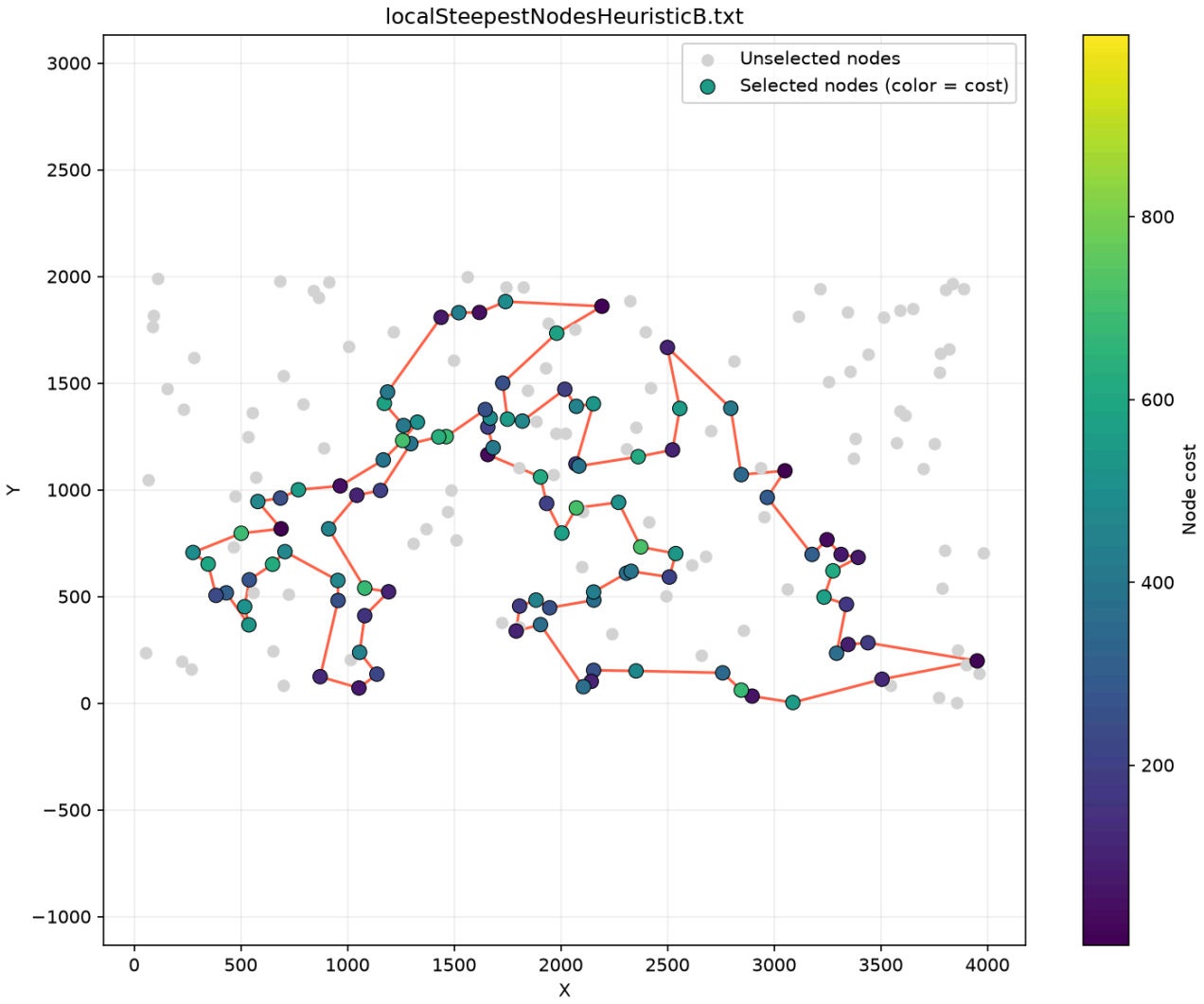
Max objective: 74658
Average objective: 73106
Min objective: 72261
Runtime: 0.247594 s




```
174 8 54 9 33 131 36 177 52 179 53 140 144 67 16 51 156 35 185 102 28 180 132 76 4
71 157 91 80 48 31 108 60 116 149 63 168 95 127 97 49 152 100 90 123 83 160 30 187
171 2 189 141 87 45 73 135 114 181 192 158 58 84 134 72 176 150 106 113 89 42 151
138 182 57 64 107 88 78 193 153 170 146 159 130 47 93 50 3 169 1 178 101 29 163
136 186 164 142 85
```

Heuristic initial solution - TSPB

Max objective: 61478
Average objective: 55898
Min objective: 52191
Runtime: 0.265595 s




```
17 171 39 99 88 179 87 82 51 85 59 73 167 181 152 34 24 67 66 11 27 111 98 151 122
69 160 172 136 133 168 189 21 47 140 97 141 40 60 157 45 134 175 71 155 115 180 6
197 36 29 132 103 178 19 170 177 125 26 154 38 176 183 30 191 130 121 198 96 48 89
156 120 8 117 72 46 86 184 3 135 76 185 57 104 162 54 192 80 127 129 90 52 182 153
74 20 14 110 2
```

All scores so far

Algorithm	TSPA max	TSPA average	TSPA min	TSPA runtime (s)	TSPB max	TSPB average	TSPB min	TSPB runtime (s)
Random	273658	255106	234696	-	221369	213252	196792	-
Nearest neighbour end only	90075	87476	84362	-	63166	59397	56007	-
Nearest neighbour	76623	74707	73176	-	67192	60635	56001	-

Algorithm	TSPA max	TSPA average	TSPA min	TSPA runtime (s)	TSPB max	TSPB average	TSPB min	TSPB runtime (s)
all possibilities								
Greedy cycle	75281	73743	72590	-	63734	59650	55655	-
Nearest neighbour 2-regret	77022	74306	72328	-	66164	59476	52915	-
Greedy cycle 2-regret	75585	73817	72886	-	63641	59371	53245	-
Nearest neighbour 2-regret weighted	77755	74513	72505	-	61579	57535	52646	-
Greedy cycle 2-regret weighted	75132	73396	72430	-	63770	58195	52834	-
Local greedy edges random	79550	76462	73699	1.19438	55870	53075	50767	1.03015
Local greedy edges heuristic	74487	**72968**	**72192**	0.176329	60241	55314	51975	0.220489
Local greedy nodes random	93632	87865	80627	1.07035	70609	64189	58613	1.06005
Local greedy nodes heuristic	74658	73114	72261	0.275943	61478	55636	52247	0.308007
Local steepest edges random	79004	76344	73968	0.771506	**54536**	**52345**	**50554**	0.639972
Local steepest edges heuristic	**74466**	72981	**72192**	**0.153551**	60144	55312	52166	**0.160574**
Local steepest	98326	89686	82908	1.08513	74250	65952	58036	0.974931

Algorithm	TSPA max	TSPA average	TSPA min	TSPA runtime (s)	TSPB max	TSPB average	TSPB min	TSPB runtime (s)
nodes random								
Local steepest nodes heuristic	74658	73106	72261	0.247594	61478	55898	52191	0.265595

Conclusions

Overall, implementing local search nicely improves scores all across the board. Even initially random solutions are capable of yielding surprisingly decent results after substantial neighbourhood exploration.

There is a noticeable time difference for both greedy and steepest approaches, where starting out with a random solution vastly increases the runtime due to a much longer search.

For TSPA, the best approach turned out to be local steepest edges with a heuristic, but the minimal objective ended up actually being tied with the greedy variant of the same approach.

For TSPB, surprisingly, the best solution ended up being derived from a random one using the local steepest edges. That fluke aside, the best heuristic-derived score ended up being a result of local greedy edges.